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Wireless communication with quasi-omni and directional beams

Abstract

Aspects of this disclosure relate to wireless communications that involve a quasi-omni beam and a directional beam, where the wireless communications involve radio frequency signals having relatively high frequency (e.g., a frequency above 20 GHz). In embodiments, a quasi-omni beam is wirelessly transmitted, a directional beam is selected based on the quasi-omni beam, and a data transmission is received over the selected directional beam.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO PRIORITY APPLICATION (1) This application claims the benefit of priority of U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/126,427, filed Dec. 16, 2020 and titled “WIRELESS COMMUNICATION WITH QUASI-OMNI AND DIRECTIONAL BEAMS,” the disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by reference herein in its entirety and for all purposes.

BACKGROUND

Technical Field

(1) Embodiments of this disclosure relate to for wireless communication systems.

Description of Related Technology

(2) The types of modern computing devices continue to increase along with the differing and dynamic needs of each device. The wireless communication systems providing services to such devices are facing increasing constraints on resources and demands for quality and quantities of service. Accordingly, improvements in providing wireless communication services, such as in a systems with wireless communication signals at frequencies above 20 gigahertz (GHz), are desired.

SUMMARY OF CERTAIN INVENTIVE ASPECTS

(3) The innovations described in the claims each have several aspects, no single one of which is solely responsible for its desirable attributes. Without limiting the scope of the claims, some prominent features of this disclosure will now be briefly described.

(4) One aspect of this disclosure is a wireless communication device that includes at least one

antenna and a processor in communication with the at least antenna. The processor is configured to cause the wireless communication device to wirelessly transmit a quasi-omni beam to a network node in a first mode and wirelessly transmit a directional beam to the network node in a second mode. The quasi-omni beam and the directional beam are each associated with a radio frequency signal having a frequency of at least 20 gigahertz.

(5) The first mode can be a training mode and the second mode can be a data transmission mode.

(6) The processor can be configured to select a directional receive beam based on the quasi-omni beam wirelessly transmitted by the network node in the first mode. The processor can configure the wireless communication device to receive a data transmission from the network node over the directional receive beam. The data transmission can be a downlink data transmission.

(7) The processor can be configured to select a directional receive beam based on a quasi-omni beam wirelessly transmitted by the network node during a training mode, and store information identifying the directional receive beam. The processor can be configured to determine to wirelessly transmit over the directional beam during a data transmission mode based on the stored information to invoke reciprocity, where the directional beam corresponds to the directional receive beam. The wireless communication device can be arranged to receive directional beams while the network node wirelessly transmits the quasi-omni beam during the training mode. The information identifying the directional receive beam can be stored in a look-up table.

(8) The directional beam can be associated with a wireless communication in compliance with an 802.11 standard. The directional beam can be associated with cellular communication.

(9) Another aspect of this disclosure is a method of wireless communication. The method includes receiving, by a wireless communication device, a quasi-omni beam wirelessly transmitted by a network node. The wireless communication device and the network node wirelessly communicate with a radio frequency signal having a frequency of at least 20 gigahertz. The method includes selecting a directional receive beam for the wireless communication device based on the quasi-omni beam wirelessly transmitted by the network node. The method also includes receiving, by the wireless communication device, data from the network node over the selected directional receive beam.

(10) The radio frequency signal can be compliance with an 802.11 standard. The radio frequency signal can be an 802.11ad signal.

(11) The radio frequency signal can be cellular signal. The radio frequency signal can have a frequency within Frequency Range 2 for New Radio.

(12) The method can include selecting a directional transmit beam for the wireless communication device, and wirelessly transmitting, by the wireless communication device, to the network node over the directional transmit beam. Selecting the directional transmit beam can be based on information identifying the directional receive beam.

(13) The method can include, while the wireless communication device is configured to receive the quasi-omni beam, receiving an indication from the network node identifying that a data transmission is coming from the network node. In response to receiving the indication, the method can include configuring the wireless communication device to receive from the network node over the directional receive beam. The indication from the network node can include an identifier included in at least one of a Request to Send (RTS) or a Clear to Send (CTS).

(14) The method can include initiating a training session that includes selecting the directional receive beam based on a request from the network node to start the training session, here the request from the network node indicates that the wireless communication device will receive a data transmission from the network node after the training session.

(15) Another aspect of this disclosure is a method of wireless communication. The method includes receiving, by a first node, a quasi-omni beam wirelessly transmitted by a second node in a training mode, wherein the first node and the second node wirelessly communicate with a radio frequency signal having a frequency of at least 20 gigahertz; configuring the first node to receive a directional

receive beam from the second node, wherein the directional receive beam is selected based on the quasi-omni beam wirelessly transmitted by the second node in the training mode; and receiving, by the first node, data from the second node over the directional receive beam in a data transmission mode.

(16) For purposes of summarizing the disclosure, certain aspects, advantages and novel features of the innovations have been described herein. It is to be understood that not necessarily all such advantages may be achieved in accordance with any particular embodiment. Thus, the innovations may be embodied or carried out in a manner that achieves or optimizes one advantage or group of advantages as taught herein without necessarily achieving other advantages as may be taught or suggested herein.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Embodiments of this disclosure will now be described, by way of non-limiting example, with reference to the accompanying drawings.

(2) FIGS. 1A, 1B, and 1C illustrate an example wireless communication environment in according with embodiments of this disclosure.

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates example horizontally polarized and vertically polarized beams.

(4) FIG. 3 includes a timing diagram for uplink and downlink transmissions in a wireless communication environment and timing diagrams associated with access point and station receiver training according to an embodiment.

(5) FIG. 4 includes a timing diagram of uplink and downlink communications together with illustrations related to communications sent between a station and an access point during particular time slots.

(6) FIG. 5 is a diagram associated with an example data transmission between a station and an access point using directional beams at both the access point and the station.

(7) FIG. 6 is a timing diagram associated with training and data transmission according to an embodiment.

(8) FIG. 7 is a diagram of an example multipoint environment in which multiple stations and access points can wirelessly communicate with each other in accordance with embodiments disclosed herein

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF CERTAIN EMBODIMENTS

(9) The following description of certain embodiments presents various descriptions of specific embodiments. However, the innovations described herein can be embodied in a multitude of different ways, for example, as defined and covered by the claims. In this description, reference is made to the drawings where like reference numerals can indicate identical or functionally similar elements. It will be understood that elements illustrated in the figures are not necessarily drawn to scale. Moreover, it will be understood that certain embodiments can include more elements than illustrated in a drawing and/or a subset of the elements illustrated in a drawing. Further, some embodiments can incorporate any suitable combination of features from two or more drawings. The headings provided herein are for convenience only and do not necessarily affect the scope or meaning of the claims.

(10) This disclosure provides technical solutions related to reliable use of the huge assets of millimeter wave (mmW) spectrum between licensed and unlicensed. The inventors realized that (1) the technology is limited in coverage by physics and (2) the technology can encounter significant link quality reduction in non-line of sight scenarios. Calls to many cells of overlapping coverages helps the range of the technology and/or increases the probability of having an access node with line of sight to the user. Umbrella coverage can be created from multiple nodes, in a way that a

terminal does not need to know or react to. This can function more like a super cell. A cloud radio access network (C-RAN) architecture can be utilized.

(11) Aspects of this disclosure relate to wireless communication between a wireless communication device and a network node with hybrid quasi-omni beam and a directional beam. This wireless communication can occur at relatively high frequencies, such as at radio frequencies of at least 20 gigahertz and/or mmW frequencies. At such relatively high frequencies, signals can be more lossy than at lower frequencies. This can present technical challenges. A wireless communication device can wirelessly transmit/receive a quasi-omni beam to/from a network node in a first mode and wirelessly transmit/receive a directional beam to/from the network node in a second mode. The first mode can be a training mode, and the second mode can be a data transmission mode. The wireless transmissions can be in compliance with an 802.11 standard, such as an 802.11ad standard. Alternatively, the wireless transmissions can be cellular communications, such as New Radio (NR) communications within Frequency Range 2 (FR2).

(12) Methods of training and wireless data transmission are disclosed. A wireless communication device can receive a quasi-omni beam wirelessly transmitted by a network node. A directional receive beam for the wireless communication device can be selected based on the quasi-omni beam wirelessly transmitted by the network node. The wireless communication device can receive downlink data from the network node over the selected directional receive beam. The wireless communications can involve radio frequency signals having a frequency of at least 20 GHz. The wireless communication device can receive an 802.11ad transmission over the directional receive beam. Wireless signals associated with 802.11ad can have a frequency in a range from about 57 GHz to about 71 GHz. The wireless communication device can receive cellular transmission over the directional receive beam, such as a NR transmission within FR2. FR2 can include radio frequency signals with a frequency of above 24 GHz. FR2 can be from 24.25 GHz to 52.6 GHz, for example, as defined in a recent NR standard.

(13) In embodiments disclosed herein, there is a training phase where a training node transmits a quasi-omni beam and a trained node receives with different beams (directional beam receiving). The training node can be referred to as a transmit node. The trained node can be referred to as a receive node. In certain instances, the transmit node can be a network node (e.g., an AP) and the receive node can be a wireless terminal (e.g., a STA). In some other instances, the transmit node can be a wireless terminal (e.g., a STA) and the receive node can be a network node (e.g., an AP). The receiving node can build a look-up table and/or otherwise store information on the best beam from each transmit node after and/or during the training period. In some instances, the trained node can use the best beam for receiving from a particular transmit node to transmit to the transmit node, invoking the assumption of reciprocity in the links.

(14) Although embodiments disclosed herein may relate to communications between a user terminal and a network node, any suitable principles and advantages disclosed herein can be applied to wireless communications within a network system and/or between user terminals. For example, in some instances, a training node and a trained node can both be part of a network system. As another example, in some other instances, a training node and a trained node can both be user terminals.

(15) During a data session after training, a transmit node can signal a receiving node that a data transmission is coming. During this phase, the receiving node is configured for quasi-omni beams. In response to the receiving node (e.g., a STA) receiving the signal indicating that the receiving node is about to receive from a specific network node (e.g., an AP), the receiving node can access the corresponding best beam with the specific network node from information stored (e.g., in a look-up table) during the training mode. Signaling from the network node to the receiving node can happen over a Request to Send (RTS) or a Clear to Send (CTS, for example, by populating the sig field with a proprietary receive node identifier. Alternatively, signaling from the network node to the receiving node can happen by the network node sending a request to the receiving node to start

training, and such a request can indicate to the receiving node that after training the receiving node should expect data from this particular network node. Thus, the receiving node can select a directional beam for receiving data from the network based on the request in this example.

(16) The transmitting node and the receiving node can each include any suitable physical hardware to perform any suitable operations disclosed herein. Each of these nodes can store computer-executable instructions that, when executed by a processor, cause the node to perform any suitable functionality disclosed herein. The processor can include a processor configured with specific executable instructions, a microprocessor, a microcontroller, a digital signal processor (DSP), an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), a programmable logic device such as field programmable gate array (FPGA), the like, or any combination thereof designed to perform any suitable combination of the functions described herein. Each node can also include any suitable number of antennas for wireless communication.

(17) FIGS. 1A, 1B, and 1C illustrate an example wireless communication environment **100**. One or more applications servers **102** are in communication with an access point (AP) controller **104**. There can be a switch **106** coupled between application servers **102** and the AP controller **104**. The AP controller **104** can be connected to a plurality of wireless APs **108A**, **108B**. The AP controller **104** and the APs **108A**, **108B** can be connected via physical connection, such as a wired and/or optical fiber connection. The APs **108A**, **108B** can wirelessly communicate with a plurality of wireless terminals **110A**, **110B**, such as stations (STAs). The APs **108A**, **108B** can be referred to as wireless APs (WAPs). The wireless terminals **110A**, **110B** can each run a respective application client **112A**, **112B**. One or more wireless terminals, such as STAs, can be associated with a respective head-mounted display (HMD) **114A**, **114B** in certain applications.

(18) The one or more application servers **102** can send data to the AP controller **104**. The AP controller **104** sends the data to APs **108A**, **108B** that wirelessly communicate with wireless terminals **110A**, **110B**. Wireless radio frequency signals with frequencies above 20 GHz and/or in the mmW range can be communicated via wireless links between the APs **108A**, **108B** and wireless terminals **110A**, **110B**. In certain applications, APs **108A**, **108B** and wireless terminals **110A**, **110B** wirelessly communicate using 802.11ad technology.

(19) As shown in FIG. 1B, wireless terminals **110A**, **110B** can send uplink reference signals. For example, the uplink sounding signals, such as an uplink Sounding Reference Signal (SRS), can be wirelessly transmitted from the wireless terminals **110A**, **110B** to the APs **108A**, **108B**. The uplink reference signals can be referred to as uplink sounding signals in certain applications. The AP controller **104** can receive uplink reference signals via APs **108A**, **108B**. The AP controller **104** can have full visibility between any wireless terminal **110A**, **110B** and any AP **108A**, **108B**. Based on the uplink reference signals, the AP controller **104** can perform downlink link selection and rate control for the APs **108A**, **108B** to wirelessly transmit data to the wireless terminals **110A**, **110B**. The AP controller **104** can direct downlink selection and rate control as shown in FIG. 1C.

(20) Millimeter wave (mmW) technology can involve beamforming for wireless communication. A set of horizontally and/or vertically polarized beams can be used by an AP and/or a STA. Example horizontally polarized beams **202A** to **202X** and vertically polarized beams **204A** to **204Y** are shown in FIG. 2. As one example, there can be 28 horizontally polarized beams and 28 vertically polarized beams. Beams are part of a codebook having a codebook size. Each beam has a beamwidth from narrow to the widest possible. The widest possible beam can be referred to as a quasi-omni beam. A quasi-omni beam can be referred to as an omni beam in certain instances. A quasi-omni beam typically has a codebook with 1 entry. In contrast to quasi-omni beams, directional beams are narrower. This mmW technology can be used in applications where radio frequency signals having frequencies of greater than 20 GHz are wirelessly transmitted.

(21) Some systems involve directional beams and beamforming at APs for wirelessly transmitting and receiving and quasi-omni beams at STAs for wirelessly transmitting and receiving. Such technical features can facilitate system design, but reduce coverage. Technology disclosed herein

provides technical solutions related to mitigating and/or overcoming this reduced coverage.

(22) When STAs send reference signals, such as pilot signals, quasi-omni beams can reach a relatively large number of APs. In larger coverage areas, STAs wirelessly communicating with quasi-omni beams can cause a performance hit. This can be due to relatively low power of wireless communication signals in such larger coverage areas.

(23) Wireless transmission and/or reception at STAs with directional beams for beamforming can be desirable. With narrower directional beams, higher power signals can be received. A STA can send a reference signal with a quasi-omni beam and then the STA can be trained so that a best beam for wirelessly receiving and/or transmitting a directional beam can be found. The directional beam can be used in beamforming. In some instances, a desirable beam that is not necessarily the best beam for wireless communication on a directional beam can be selected in accordance with any suitable principles and advantages disclosed herein.

(24) FIG. 3 is a diagram associated with each AP selecting a best receive beam for each STA through training and each STA selecting a best receive beam for each AP through training. FIG. 3 includes a timing diagram 300 for uplink and downlink transmissions in a wireless communication environment, such as the wireless communication environment 100 shown in FIGS. 1A to 1C. During time slot 320, AP receiver training is performed. FIG. 3 includes a timing diagram 325 related to AP receiver training during the time slot 320. During time slot 340, STA receiver training is performed. The time slot 340 can be part of a downlink transmission time slot. FIG. 3 includes a timing diagram 345 related to STA receiver training during the time slot 340. Training can be periodic. As one example, training can occur every video frame and/or about every 11 milliseconds (ms).

(25) AP training can involve periodic instances of a beam refinement protocol (BRP). The timing diagram 325 illustrates timing of APs receiving from a STA for a BRP. During this process, STAs 110A to 110M transmit quasi-omni beams and APs are receiving on directional beams. For each instance, STAs 110A to 110M can time division multiplex (TDM) in back-to-back slots. STAs can transmit one at a time from STA 1 to STA M during different time slots. The timing diagram 325 illustrates timing for APs receiving from one STA 110A. In each slot, the STA 110A transmits a quasi-omni beam over multiple instances and an AP can sweep different receiving beams. During any STA transmission, such as a STA 1 transmission, all APs can listen concurrently on beam 1, then the APs can switch to beam 2 and so on until beam K. At the end of the training period where each STA 110A to 110M transmits, the AP has a quantitative measure of link quality for the link of each receive beam with each STA. The best receive beam for the AP can be selected for each corresponding STA. The selected receive beam can be used by the AP as a directional beam for receiving. The best receive beam can be used as a transmit beam for the AP to transmit to the corresponding STA if channel reciprocity is invoked. If channel reciprocity is not invoked, the training can be performed where each STA receives with a quasi-omni beam and each AP 108A to 108N sweeps its transmit beam. Then a transmit beam can be selected based on the sweep. The training can be defined in a standards procedure for BRP for receiving and/or transmitting.

(26) Periodic training procedures can be repeated periodically for the STA training in a mirrored fashion. APs 108A to 108N can transmit quasi-omni beams to STAs. The APs 108A to 108N can TDM in back-to-back slots. The timing diagram 345 illustrates timing for STAs receiving from one AP 108A. In each slot, the AP 108A transmits a quasi-omni beam over multiple instances. A STA can sweep different receive beams. During any AP transmission, such as an AP 108A transmission, all STAs can listen concurrently on beam 1, then the STAs can switch to beam 2 and so on until beam B. At the end of the training period where each AP 108A to 108N transmits, the STA has a quantitative measure of link quality for the link of each receive beam with each AP. The STA can select a best receive beam for each AP. The selected receive beam can be used by the STA as a directional beam for receiving a data transmission. The STA can use channel reciprocity and/or additional training to determine a best transmit beam for each AP.

(27) The training procedures can refresh a database of beams between AP and STAs for transmit and/or receive each period.

(28) FIG. 4 is a diagram associated with an example data transmission between a STA and an AP using directional beams at both the AP and the STA. FIG. 4 includes a timing diagram 400 of uplink and downlink communications together with illustrations related to specific communications sent between the STA and the AP during particular time slots. Before data transmission, the STA can transmit quasi-omni beams for training, for example, as discussed above. For downlink data transmission between an AP and a STA, a particular AP can be identified to the STA for the STA to select a directional beam for wireless communication with the particular AP. The selected directional beam can be used in beamforming.

(29) Downlink data transmission during downlink time slot 420 will now be discussed. Before downlink data transmission, a given AP-STA link can be established by an AP sending a Request to Send (RTS) to the STA with an identifier of the STA at communication 422. For example, the RTS can include the index of the STA added in the sig field. The STA can be operating with quasi-omni beams at this stage. The STA can transmit a quasi-omni beam and an AP can receive on a directional beam for the communication 422. The RTS can let a given STA know that the STA will be receiving. The intended STA can select the best directional beam the STA has with the initiating AP (from the training session). The STA can use the selected directional beam for a Clear to Send (CTS) at communication 424 and receiving a data downlink data transmission from an AP to a STA at communication 426. For the CTS, the STA transmits with a directional beam and the AP receives with the selected directional beam. For the downlink data transmission, the AP transmits with a directional beam and the STA receives with the selected directional beam. The selected directional beam can be used in beamforming.

(30) Uplink data transmission can be a mirrored equivalent of downlink data transmission. An uplink data transmission for uplink time slot 440 will now be discussed. A STA can send an RTS to an AP with an AP index at communication 442. The STA can transmit a direction beam and the AP can receive quasi-omni for communication 442. The AP can use the selected directional beam for a CTS at communication 444, where the AP transmits a directional beam and the STA receives a directional beam. The STA can then send uplink data to the AP on a selected beam at communication 446. In the uplink data transmission, a STA transmits with the selected directional beam and the AP receives with a directional beam. The selected directional beam can be used in beamforming.

(31) FIG. 5 is a diagram associated with an example data transmission between a STA and an AP using directional beams at both the AP and the STA. To avoid use of a STA/AP index in downlink/uplink initiation, a BRP phase can be used for training the AP and/or the STA in certain applications. A BRP set-up sub-phase communication 512 and a BRP receive communication 514 can be implemented in place of RTS and CTS communications 422 and 424 or 442 and 444. The intended node can use a beam based on pre-training and/or based on any suitable training session disclosed herein. A training can be performed to select a best directional beam for a STA to wirelessly communicate with an AP. Then the selected beam can be used to wirelessly communicate data between the AP and the STA. With this solution, a combined procedure for a training session and data transmission can be performed. Accordingly, a separate dedicated periodic training may not be needed. The training and data transmission in FIG. 5 can involve 802.11ad compliant packets in certain applications.

(32) FIG. 6 is a timing diagram 600 that illustrates training and data transmission. This training and data transmission can be performed in accordance with any suitable principles and advantages disclosed herein.

(33) The timing diagram 600 includes a beacon and calibration time slot followed by 9 video frame slots. The beacon and calibration time slot is 1 ms in FIG. 6. Each video frame is 11 ms in FIG. 6. The beacon interval is 100 ms in FIG. 6. Each video frame can include at least one BRP receive at

STAs and at least one BRP receive at APs. Wireless data communications between APs and STAs using directional beams at both the APs and the STAs can be performed in accordance with any suitable principles and advantages discussed with reference to FIG. 4 and/or FIG. 5.

(34) The BRP receive at STAs can be during a downlink slot **340A**, **340B**, **340C** at the beginning of the video frame. The BRP at the STAs can select a best receive beam for each AP. This can be implemented in accordance with any suitable principles and advantages discussed with reference to the timing diagram **345** of FIG. 3.

(35) The BRP receive at APs can be during an uplink slot **320A**, **320B** of a video frame. The BRP at the APs can select a best receive beam for each STA. This can be implemented in accordance with any suitable principles and advantages discussed with reference to the timing diagram **325** of FIG. 3.

(36) Downlink data can be transmitted from one or more APs to one or more STAs during downlink time slot **420** in accordance with any suitable principles and advantages discussed with reference to FIGS. 4 and/or 5. Such downlink data transmission can be implemented in one or more downlink time slots in each video frame.

(37) Uplink data can be transmitted from one or more APs to one or more STAs during uplink time slot **440** in accordance with any suitable principles and advantages discussed with reference to FIGS. 4 and/or 5. Such uplink data transmission can be implemented in one or more uplink time slots in each video frame.

(38) Although embodiments disclosed herein can be discussed with reference to STAs and APs for illustrative purposes, any suitable principles and advantages disclosed herein can be applied to wireless communication between wireless communication devices and network nodes. For example, in certain cellular applications, a wireless communication device can be a user equipment and a network node can be a remote radio unit (RRU) of a cellular network. Moreover, any suitable principles and advantages disclosed herein can be applied to wireless communication between a plurality of wireless communication nodes. Such wireless communication nodes can include a plurality of network nodes. Alternatively or additionally, such wireless communication nodes can include a plurality of user wireless communication terminals.

(39) Wireless communication devices can include one or more antennas and a processor configured to cause the wireless communication device to perform any suitable functionality of a wireless communication device disclosed herein. The wireless communication device can include any suitable physical hardware to perform any of the operations do the wireless communication devices disclosed herein. The wireless communication device can store computer-executable instructions that, when executed by the processor, cause the wireless communication device to perform any suitable functionality disclosed herein. The processor can include a processor configured with specific executable instructions, a microprocessor, a microcontroller, a digital signal processor (DSP), an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), a programmable logic device such as field programmable gate array (FPGA), the like, or any combination thereof designed to perform any suitable combination of the functions described herein. The processor can be implemented by any suitable combination of computing devices and/or discrete processing circuits in certain applications. The processor can be programmed by specific executable instructions to perform a method with any suitable combination of features disclosed herein. The processor can perform baseband processing. Such a processor can be referred to as a baseband processor. The one or more antennas can wirelessly transmit and/or receive with both quasi-omni beams and directional beams.

(40) FIG. 7 is a diagram of an example multipoint environment **700** in which multiple STAs **110A** to **110D** and APs **108A** to **108I** can communicate with each other in accordance with any suitable principles and advantages disclosed herein. The illustrated STAs and APs are examples of devices that can perform any suitable training and/or data selection disclosed herein. The STAs are example wireless terminals. The APs are example network nodes. The APs can be referred to as serving nodes. As illustrated in FIG. 7, the multipoint environment **700** includes a plurality of APs **108A** to

108I, a plurality of STAs **110A** to **110D**, an AP controller **104**, and a baseband unit **740**. In an embodiment, data packets can be wirelessly transmitted from the baseband unit **740** to the plurality of STAs **110A** to **110D** via one or more of the APs **108A** to **108I**. Similarly, data packets can be transmitted from the plurality of STAs **110A** to **110D** to one or more APs **108A** to **108I**.

(41) A STA **110A** to **110D** can communicate with multiple APs **108A** to **108I** and an AP **108A** to **108I** can communicate with multiple STAs **110A** to **110D** in a single wireless stack (e.g., a single IEEE 802.11 protocol stack). For example, a STA **110A** to **110D** can authenticate concurrently with multiple APs **108A** to **108I** and decode any data packet that includes a destination address that matches an address of the STA **110A** to **110D** in a header and/or preamble, irrespective of the source address included in the header or preamble of the data packet. Similarly, an AP **108A** to **108I** can decode any data packet that includes a destination address that matches an address of the AP **108A** to **108I** or that matches a wildcard address associated with the AP **108A** to **108I** in a header or preamble, irrespective of the source address included in the header of the data packet. For example, a wildcard address may be an address associated with multiple APs **108A** to **108I** rather than a unique address associated with just one AP **108A** to **108I**.

(42) For the purposes of illustration and not meant to be limiting, STA **110A** communicates with APs **108A** and **108B**, STA **110B** communicates with APs **108B** and **108E**, STA **110C** communicates with APs **108D**, **108E**, and **108H**, and STA **110D** communicates with APs **108E** and **108H**. The STAs **110A** to **110D** and APs **108A** to **108I**, however, can communicate with other APs **108A** to **108I** and/or STAs **110A** to **110D**. Thus, unlike wireless network environments in which a basic service set (BSS) includes one AP assigned to one or more STAs, the multipoint environment **700** has no pre-defined AP **108A** to **108I** to which a STA **110A** to **110D** is associated. Rather, the AP **108A** to **108I** transmitting a data packet to a particular STA **110A** to **110D** can change on a packet-by-packet basis. For example, the AP **108D** can transmit a first data packet to the STA **110C** at a first time, the AP **108E** can transmit a second data packet to the STA **110C** at a second time, the AP **108H** can transmit a third data packet to the STA **110C** at a third time, the AP **108D** can transmit a fourth data packet to the STA **110C** at a fourth time, and so on. In fact, the AP **108A** to **108I** that transmits a data packet to the STA **110A** to **110D** can change without the STA **110A** to **110D** changing BSSs to which the STA **110A** to **110D** is associated—the STA **110A** to **110D** may remain in the same BSS using the same, single wireless stack while the AP **108A** to **108I** that transmits data packets to the STA **110A** to **110D** changes. Similarly, there may be no pre-defined STA **110A** to **110D** to which an AP **108A** to **108I** is associated. Rather, the STA **110A** to **110D** transmitting a data packet to a particular AP **108A** to **108I** can change on a packet-by-packet basis.

(43) The AP controller **104** can be configured to select the AP **108A** to **108I** to transmit a data packet to a STA **110A** to **110D**. For example, the AP controller **104** can route traffic to one or more APs **108A** to **108I** for transmission to one or more STAs **110A** to **110D** based on downlink and/or uplink channel quality measurements. The AP controller **104** can be in communication with one or more application servers. A downlink (DL) transmission generally refers to a communication from a network system (e.g., an AP) to a user terminal (e.g., a STA). An uplink (UL) transmission generally refers to a communication from the user terminal to the network system.

(44) The APs **108A** to **108I** may each have one or more transmit antennas that each support one or more digital basebands. In some embodiments, each AP **108A** to **108I** has the same number of transmit antennas. In other embodiments, some or all APs **108A** to **108I** have a different number of transmit antennas than other APs **108A** to **108I**. Thus, the APs **108A** to **108I** may collectively be capable of transmitting N spatial beams, where N is the product of the number of APs **108A** to **108I** in the multipoint environment **700** and the number of transmit antennas operated by a single AP **108A** to **108I**. Similarly, each AP **108A** to **108I** can have the same number or different number of receive antennas. The baseband unit **740**, the AP controller **104**, and/or the APs **108A** to **108I** can be collectively referred to herein as a “network system.”

(45) Various standards and protocols may be included in the multipoint environment **700** to

wirelessly communicate data between a network node (e.g., an AP **108**) and a wireless communication device (e.g., a STA **110**). Some wireless devices may communicate using an IEEE 802.11 standard, which may be known as Wi-Fi. As an example, the IEEE 802.11 standard can be an 802.11ad standard. While the multipoint environment **700** may be described with terminology that can be associated with Wi-Fi, any suitable principles and advantages associated with the multipoint environment **700** can be applied to communications with any suitable communication standards and/or protocols, such as third generation partnership project (3GPP) New Radio (NR).

(46) The wireless communication device may be referred to as a station (STA) (e.g., for wireless communication devices that communicate using the IEEE 802.11 standard). The wireless communication device may also be referred to as a UE (e.g., for wireless communication devices that communicate in a RAN). The wireless communication device may be a device used by a user such as cellular telephone, a smartphone, a laptop, an extended reality terminal, a wireless device integrated with a head mounted display, a tablet computer, a wearable computing device such as smart glasses or a smart watch or an ear piece, one or more networked appliances (e.g., consumer networked appliances or industrial plant equipment), an industrial robot with connectivity, or a vehicle. In some implementations, the STA may include a sensor or other networked device configured to collect data and wirelessly provide the data to a device (e.g., server) connected to a core network such as the Internet. Such devices may be referred to as Internet of Things devices (IoT devices). In some instances, a wireless communication device can be a network node.

(47) The AP controller **104** can function as a router to route traffic between the baseband unit **740** and the APs **108A** to **108I**. The AP controller **104** can implement a relatively small amount of buffering. This can contribute to the AP controller **104** routing data between the baseband unit **740** and the APs **108A** to **108I** with low latency.

(48) The APs **108A** to **108I** can be arranged as an array. All of the APs **108A** to **108I** can be connected to the AP controller **104**. The APs **108A** to **108I** can be connected to the AP controller **104** via wired or wireless connections. Each AP **108A** to **108I** can buffer a relatively low amount of frames of data at a time. For example, an AP **108A** can buffer 1 or 2 frames of data at a time in certain applications. The frames can be relatively big frames. For example, one frame can include 100 to 150 Internet protocol (IP) packets. The APs **108A** to **108I** are arranged to wirelessly communicate with STAs **110A** to **110D**. The APs **108A** to **108I** can communicate via any suitable wireless links, such as wireless local area network (WLAN) links. WLAN signals can have a shorter signal range than cellular signals. In some instances, the WLAN signals can have a range of about 300 feet or less. WLAN signals can have a range of about 150 feet or less in certain applications. An example of a WLAN link is a Wi-Fi link. The WLAN link can be implemented based on an IEEE 802.11 standard, such as an IEEE 802.11ad standard. The APs **108A** to **108I** are networking hardware devices that include any suitable physical hardware to implement the functionalities disclosed herein. Although APs are described with reference to certain embodiments for illustrative purposes, any suitable principles and advantages described with references to access points can be implemented with any other suitable serving nodes of a network system. In some instances, there can be one or more wireless hops between network nodes. Any suitable wireless link that meets latency and throughput specifications can be used. Wi-Fi links, millimeter wave (mmW) wireless area network (WAN) links, and fifth generation (5G) New Radio (NR) links in Frequency Range 2 (FR2) are examples of such suitable wireless links.

(49) Depending on the embodiment, certain acts, events, or functions of any of the processes or algorithms described herein can be performed in a different sequence, can be added, merged, or left out altogether (e.g., not all described operations or events are necessary for the practice of the process or algorithm). Moreover, in certain embodiments, operations, or events can be performed concurrently, e.g., through multi-threaded processing, interrupt processing, or multiple processors or processor cores or on other parallel architectures, rather than sequentially. Any suitable combination of parallel and/or sequential execution of a method disclosed herein can be performed.

(50) Conditional language used herein, such as, “can,” “could,” “might,” “may,” “e.g.,” “such as,” and the like, unless specifically stated otherwise, or otherwise understood within the context as used, is generally intended to convey that certain embodiments include, while other embodiments do not include, certain features, elements, and/or operations. Thus, such conditional language is not generally intended to imply that features, elements, and/or operations are in any way required for one or more embodiments or that one or more embodiments necessarily include logic for deciding, with or without other input or prompting, whether these features, elements, and/or steps are included or are to be performed in any particular embodiment. The terms “comprising,” “including,” and the like are synonymous and are used inclusively, in an open-ended fashion, and do not exclude additional elements, features, acts, operations, and so forth. Additionally, the words “herein,” “above,” “below,” and words of similar import, when used in this application, shall refer to this application as a whole and not to any particular portions of this application. Where the context permits, words in the above Detailed Description of Certain Embodiments using the singular or plural may also include the plural or singular, respectively. Also, the term “or” is used in its inclusive sense (and not in its exclusive sense) so that when used, for example, to connect a list of elements, the term “or” means one, some, or all of the elements in the list.

(51) Disjunctive language such as the phrase “at least one of X, Y, Z,” unless specifically stated otherwise, is otherwise understood with the context as used in general to present that an item, term, etc., may be either X, Y, or Z, or any combination thereof (e.g., X, Y, and/or Z). Thus, such disjunctive language is not generally intended to, and should not, imply that certain embodiments require at least one of X, at least one of Y, or at least one of Z to each be present.

(52) Unless otherwise explicitly stated or generally understood from context, articles such as “a” or “an” should generally be interpreted to include one or more described items. Accordingly, phrases such as “a device configured to” are intended to include one or more recited devices. Such one or more recited devices can also be collectively configured to carry out the stated recitations. For example, “a processor configured to carry out recitations A, B and C” can include a first processor configured to carry out recitation A working in conjunction with a second processor configured to carry out recitations B and C.

(53) The word “coupled,” as generally used herein, refers to two or more elements that may be either directly coupled to each other, or coupled by way of one or more intermediate elements. Likewise, the word “connected,” as generally used herein, refers to two or more elements that may be either directly connected, or connected by way of one or more intermediate elements. Connections can be via an air interface and/or via wires and/or via optical fiber and/or via any other suitable connection.

(54) As used herein, the terms “determine” or “determining” encompass a wide variety of actions. For example, “determining” may include calculating, computing, processing, deriving, generating, obtaining, looking up (e.g., looking up in a table, a database or another data structure), ascertaining and the like via a hardware element without user intervention. Also, “determining” may include receiving (e.g., receiving information), accessing (e.g., accessing data in a memory) and the like via a hardware element without user intervention. Also, “determining” may include resolving, selecting, choosing, establishing, and the like via a hardware element without user intervention.

(55) While the above detailed description has shown, described, and pointed out novel features as applied to various embodiments, it can be understood that various omissions, substitutions, and changes in the form and details of the devices or algorithms illustrated can be made without departing from the spirit of the disclosure. For example, circuit blocks and/or method blocks described herein may be deleted, moved, added, subdivided, combined, arranged in a different order, and/or modified. Each of these blocks may be implemented in a variety of different ways. Any portion of any of the methods disclosed herein can be performed in association with specific instructions stored on a non-transitory computer readable storage medium being executed by one or

more processors. As can be recognized, certain embodiments described herein can be embodied within a form that does not provide all of the features and benefits set forth herein, as some features can be used or practiced separately from others. The scope of certain embodiments disclosed herein is indicated by the appended claims rather than by the foregoing description. All changes which come within the meaning and range of equivalency of the claims are to be embraced within their scope.

Claims

1. A wireless communication device comprising: at least one antenna; and a processor in communication with the at least one antenna, wherein the processor is configured to cause the wireless communication device to: wirelessly transmit a quasi-omni beam to a network node in a training mode such that the quasi-omni beam is time division multiplexed with a second quasi-omni beam received by the network node from another wireless communication device in a time slot for the training mode; select a directional receive beam based on a third quasi-omni beam wirelessly transmitted by the network node during another training mode, wherein the wireless communication device is arranged to receive directional beams while the network node wirelessly transmits the third quasi-omni beam; determine to wirelessly transmit a directional beam during a data transmission mode based on stored information identifying the directional receive beam to invoke reciprocity, wherein the directional beam corresponds to the directional receive beam; and wirelessly transmit the directional beam to the network node in the data transmission mode, wherein the quasi-omni beam and the directional beam are each associated with a radio frequency signal having a frequency of at least 20 gigahertz.
2. The wireless communication device of claim 1, wherein the processor is further configured to: select another directional receive beam based on the quasi-omni beam wirelessly transmitted by the network node in the training mode; and configure the wireless communication device to receive a data transmission from the network node over the another directional receive beam.
3. The wireless communication device of claim 1, wherein the information identifying the directional receive beam is stored in a look-up table.
4. The wireless communication device of claim 1, wherein the directional beam is associated with a wireless communication in compliance with an 802.11 standard.
5. The wireless communication device of claim 1, wherein the directional beam is associated with cellular communication.
6. A method of wireless communication, the method comprising: receiving, by a wireless communication device during a time slot for a training mode for the wireless communication device, a quasi-omni beam wirelessly transmitted by a network node and a second quasi-omni beam wirelessly transmitted by a second network node, wherein the quasi-omni beam and the second quasi-omni beam are time division multiplexed during the time slot for the training mode for the wireless communication device, wherein the wireless communication device and the network node wirelessly communicate with a radio frequency signal having a frequency of at least 20 gigahertz; selecting a directional receive beam for the wireless communication device based on the quasi-omni beam wirelessly transmitted by the network node; selecting a second directional receive beam for the wireless communication device based on the second quasi-omni beam wirelessly transmitted by the second network node; receiving, by the wireless communication device, data from the network node over the selected directional receive beam and data from the second network node over the selected second directional receive beam during a data transmission mode following the time slot for the training mode for the wireless communication device; and transmitting data over a directional transmit beam to the network node based on stored information identifying the directional received beam to invoke reciprocity.
7. The method of claim 6, wherein the radio frequency signal in compliance with an 802.11

standard.

8. The method of claim 6, wherein the radio frequency signal is an 802.11ad signal.

9. The method of claim 6, wherein the radio frequency signal is cellular signal.

10. The method of claim 6, wherein the radio frequency signal has a frequency within Frequency Range 2 for New Radio.

11. The method of claim 6, further comprising: while the wireless communication device is configured to receive the quasi-omni beam, receiving an indication from the network node identifying that a data transmission is coming from the network node; and in response to said receiving the indication, configuring the wireless communication device to receive from the network node over the directional receive beam.

12. The method of claim 11, wherein the indication from the network node comprises an identifier included in at least one of a Request to Send (RTS) or a Clear to Send (CTS).

13. The method of claim 6, further comprising initiating a training session that comprises said selecting based on a request from the network node to start the training session, wherein the request from the network node indicates that the wireless communication device will receive a data transmission from the network node after the training session.

14. A method of wireless communication, the method comprising: receiving, by a first node, a first quasi-omni beam wirelessly transmitted by a second node in a training mode and a second quasi-omni beam wirelessly transmitted by a third node in a time slot for the training mode, wherein the second node and the third node time division multiplex the first quasi-omni beam and the second quasi-omni beam, wherein the first node and the second node wirelessly communicate with a radio frequency signal having a frequency of at least 20 gigahertz; configuring the first node to receive a first directional receive beam from the second node and a second directional receive beam from the third node, wherein the first directional receive beam is selected based on the first quasi-omni beam wirelessly transmitted by the second node in the time slot for the training mode, and wherein the second directional receive beam is selected based on the second quasi-omni beam wirelessly transmitted by the third node in the time slot for the training mode; receiving, by the first node, data from the second node over the first directional receive beam in a data transmission mode and data from the third node over the second directional receive beam in the data transmission mode; and transmitting, by the first node, data over a directional transmit beam to the second node based on stored information identifying the first directional receive beam to invoke reciprocity.

15. The method of claim 14, wherein the first node receives the first quasi-omni beam transmitted by the second node and the second quasi-omni beam transmitted by the third node in back-to-back slots in the training mode.

16. The method of claim 6, wherein the wireless communication device, the network node, and the second network node are in a multipoint environment while the method is performed, and wherein multiple network nodes and multiple wireless communication devices wirelessly communicate with each other in the multipoint environment.

17. The wireless communication device of claim 1, wherein the processor is configured to process a plurality of quasi-omni beams received during a time slot for the another training mode, the plurality of quasi-omni beams are time division multiplexed with each other, and the plurality of quasi-omni beams including the third quasi-omni beam.

18. The method of claim 6, further comprising transmitting a third quasi-omni beam to the network mode such that the third quasi-omni beam is time division multiplexed with a fourth quasi-omni beam transmitted from a second wireless communication device during a time slot for a training mode for the network node.
